5. He greeted me with his usual smile and **banter**.

a) flattery b) small talk

c) chitchat d) repartee.

c. Words can be combined to form compound nouns. Compound nouns often have a meaning that is different, or more specific, than the two separate words. The elements in a compound noun are very diverse parts of speech.

Some compound words from the story have been listed below.

Compound elements	Words
Noun+Noun	Storeroom, buttermilk
Noun + Adjective	Diamond-hard
Adjective+ Noun	Grandmother, milchcow
Adverb+verb	overstep

Identify the correct combination of the following compound words.

Haircut, headmaster, waterfall, swimming pool, drawback, public speaking, output, software, show cause, world famous.

d. Look at the following sentence from the text.

"The whole house **spluttered** into giggles before things settled down".

The word "**spluttered**" is the blended form of splash and sputter.

A portmanteau is a type of blend word in which the beginning of one word is combined with the final part of another word. Let's take a look at some of the most common portmanteaus in English.

alphanumeric = **alpha**betic + **numeric**

brunch = **br**eakfast + l**unch**

camcorder = **cam**era + re**corder**

mechatronics = **mecha**nics + elec**tronics**

newscast = **news** + broad**cast**

smog = **sm**oke + f**og**.

Now, Blend the following words.

1. binary + digit
2. electronic + mail
3. foreign + exchange
4. motor + pedal
5. parachute + troop

e. The term euphemism refers to polite, indirect expressions that replace words and phrases considered harsh and impolite, or which suggest something unpleasant.

When we wish to refer to a person as an old, We use the term " senior citizen" instead of 'old'.

Replace the underlined word/ expressions with possibly polite forms.

a. The culprit was sent to <u>jail</u>.

b. Dheeraj is <u>unemployed</u>.

c. I saw a <u>disabled</u> man.

d. Subsidies are given to the <u>poor</u>.

e. Elambrathi has a <u>second-hand</u> car.

12th General_English_Unit_5_A_Prose.indd 150 07-12-2021 18:13:05